“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Madhya-līlā

Chapter 18

Śrī Caitanya in Vṛndāvana

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 Delighting the moving and nonmoving beings of Vṛndāvana with His glances, and delighting Himself by the sight of them, Gaurāṅga wandered all around.

2 Glory, glory to Gauracandra! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura![1]

3 Dancing and dancing in this way, Mahāprabhu came to Āriṭ-grāma, and there His outer awareness suddenly returned.

4 In Ariṣṭa He asked the people about Rādhā-kuṇḍa, but no one could tell Him, and the brāhmaṇa with Him did not know either.

5 The Lord, the all-knowing Bhagavān, knew that the holy place had been lost to sight, and He bathed in the shallow water of two rice fields.

6 Seeing this, all the villagers were astonished. Then, full of love, the Lord praised Rādhā-kuṇḍa:

7 Of all the gopīs, Rādhā is Kṛṣṇa’s dearest. So too Rādhā-kuṇḍa is dear to Him: it is the lake of His beloved.

8 “As Rādhā is dear to Viṣṇu, so is Her pond dear to Him; among all the gopīs She alone is His most beloved.” (Padma Purāṇa; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Uttara-khaṇḍa, 45)[2]

9 In this kuṇḍa Kṛṣṇa eternally sports with Rādhikā in the water, and on its bank He delights in the rāsa dance.

10 To anyone who bathes in that kuṇḍa even once, Kṛṣṇa gives love like Rādhā’s own.

11 The sweetness of the kuṇḍa is like Rādhā’s own charm, and the glory of the kuṇḍa is like Rādhā’s own glory.

12 “By its own wondrous qualities Her lake is as dear to Hari as Śrī Rādhā Herself. In it the beautiful moon Mādhava ceaselessly sports with Her in love, and whoever bathes in it even once gains love for Him like Rādhikā’s. Who on earth could describe its glory and its sweetness?” (Govinda-līlāmṛta 7.102)

13 Absorbed in love, He offered these praises, and He danced on the bank, remembering the pastimes of the kuṇḍa.

14 He took clay from the kuṇḍa and marked Himself with tilaka, and He had the Bhaṭṭācārya carry some of the clay along.

15 Then the Lord went on to Sumanaḥ-sarovara. There He saw Govardhana and was overwhelmed.

16 Seeing Govardhana, the Lord fell down like a rod in obeisance. He embraced a rock of Govardhana and became mad with love.

17 Intoxicated with love, He went on to the village of Govardhana. There He saw Harideva and bowed down before Him.

18 Harideva, who dwells on the western petal of the lotus of Mathurā, is Nārāyaṇa, the original manifestation.

19 Intoxicated with love, He danced before Harideva, and all the people, hearing of the wonder, came to see.

20 The people were amazed to see the Lord's love and beauty, and the servant of Harideva received the Lord with honour.

21 The Bhaṭṭācārya went to Brahma-kuṇḍa and cooked there, and the Lord bathed in Brahma-kuṇḍa and took His meal.

22 That night He stayed in the temple of Harideva, and in the night Mahāprabhu reflected in His mind:

23 "I shall never climb onto Govardhana. How, then, shall I have darśana of Gopāla-rāya?"

24 Thinking this, the Lord kept silent. Gopāla knew His mind and raised a pretext: fear of the mlecchas.

25 Gaura — Kṛṣṇa Himself — regarded Himself as a devotee and would not climb the hill; so Kṛṣṇa came down from the hill and showed Himself to Him.

26 Gopāla resided in the village called Annakūṭa, and the people of that village were Rajputs.

27 One night a man came and told the villagers: "Turkish troops have armed themselves to raid your village.

28 Flee tonight, and let not a single person remain. Take the Deity and run, for the yavanas will come tomorrow."

29 Hearing this, the villagers grew anxious. First of all they took Gopāla and placed Him in the village of Gāṭholi.

30 In a brāhmaṇa's house Gopāla was served in secret. The village was deserted, for everyone had fled.

31 In this way, for fear of the mlecchas, Gopāla flees again and again: He leaves His temple and stays in a grove or in another village.

32 In the morning the Lord bathed in Mānasa-gaṅgā and set out to circle Govardhana.

33 Seeing Govardhana, the Lord was overcome with love, and He went on, dancing and dancing and reciting this verse:

34 "Ah, friends, this hill is the best of Hari's servants! Thrilled by the touch of the feet of Rāma and Kṛṣṇa, it honours Them, together with Their cows and companions, with water to drink, fine grass, caves, and bulbs and roots." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.21.18)[3]

35 The Lord bathed at Govinda-kuṇḍa and other holy places, and there He heard that Gopāla was in the village of Gāṭholi.

36 He went to that village and had darśana of Gopāla, and in the rapture of love the Lord sang and danced.

37 Seeing the beauty of Gopāla, the Lord was enraptured. Reciting this verse, He danced until the day was over:

38 "May the left arm of the lotus-eyed Lord protect you — the arm by which Govardhana Hill was made a ball for His play." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu 2.1.62)

39 In this way He beheld Gopāla for three days, and on the fourth day Gopāla went back to His own temple.

40 He went along with Gopāla, dancing and singing, and in a joyful uproar the people cried, “Hari! Hari!”

41 Gopāla went to His temple, and the Lord remained below. Gopāla had fulfilled all the Lord’s desires.

42 Such is Gopāla’s compassionate nature. Those devotees long to see Him,

43 they are eager to see Him, yet they do not climb Govardhana — and so, on some pretext, Gopāla comes down Himself.

44 Sometimes He stays in a grove, sometimes in another village, and any devotee may come there and see Him.

45 The two brothers, Rūpa and Sanātana, would not climb the hill, and in this way He gave them darśana.

46 In his old age Rūpa Gosāñi could no longer go there, yet a desire arose in him to see the beauty of Gopāla.

47 For fear of the mlecchas Gopāla came to the city of Mathurā and stayed for a month in the house of Viṭhṭhaleśvara.

48 Then Rūpa Gosāñi took all his associates with him, stayed in Mathurā for a month and had darśana of Gopāla.

49 With him were Gopāla Bhaṭṭa, Raghunātha dāsa, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa Gosāñi and Lokanātha,

50 Bhūgarbha Gosāñi, Śrī Jīva Gosāñi, Śrī Yādava Ācārya, Govinda Gosāñi,

51 Śrī Uddhava dāsa and Mādhava, Śrī Gopāla dāsa and Nārāyaṇa dāsa,

52 the devotee Govinda, Vāṇī Kṛṣṇadāsa, Puṇḍarīkākṣa, Īśāna and Laghu Haridāsa.

53 Taking all these chief devotees with him, he had darśana of Śrī Gopāla with great joy.

54 After staying for a month, Gopāla went back to His own place, and Śrī Rūpa Gosāñi returned to Śrī Vṛndāvana.

55 In passing I have told the story of Gopāla's mercy. Then Mahāprabhu went to Śrī Kāmyavana.

56 In the manner of travelling that I described before, the Lord saw all the holy places of Vṛndāvana.

57 After seeing the places of the pastimes there, He went to Nandīśvara, and on seeing Nandīśvara He was overwhelmed with love.

58 He bathed in all the kuṇḍas, beginning with Pāvana, and then He went up the hill and asked the people:

59 "Are there any Deities on the hill?" The people said, "There are Deities inside a cave.

60 On either side are the mother and father, sturdy of build, and between them is a child, beautiful in His threefold bending form."

61 Mahāprabhu was delighted to hear this. He opened the cave and saw the three Deities.

62 He bowed to the feet of the King and Queen of Vraja, and in the rapture of love He touched Kṛṣṇa's whole body.

63 All day He danced and sang in the rapture of love, and from there Mahāprabhu came to Khadiravana.

64 After seeing the places of the pastimes there, He went to Śeṣaśāyī. There, seeing Lakṣmī, the Lord recited this verse:

65 "O dear one, Your tender lotus feet we place gently on our hard breasts, afraid to hurt them — and with those feet You wander through the forest! Are they not hurt by the sharp pebbles? You are our very life, and our minds are reeling." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.31.19)[4]

66 Then, after seeing Khelā-tīrtha, He came to Bhāṇḍīravana, and crossing the Yamunā He went to Bhadravana.

67 After seeing Śrīvana He went on to Lohavana, and going to Mahāvana He saw the place of Kṛṣṇa's birth.

68 He saw the places where the twin Arjuna trees were broken and where other pastimes took place, and in the rapture of love the Lord's mind was deeply stirred.

69 After seeing Gokula, He came to the city of Mathurā. He saw the place of Kṛṣṇa's birth and stayed in the house of that same brāhmaṇa.

70 Seeing the crowds of people, He left Mathurā and came to stay in solitude at Akrūra-tīrtha.

71 The next day the Lord came to see Vṛndāvana, and He bathed in Kālīya-hrada and in Praskandana.

72 From Dvādaśāditya He came to Keśī-tīrtha, and on seeing the place of the rāsa dance He fainted with love.

73 Regaining consciousness, He rolled on the ground again; He laughed, wept, danced, fell down and sang at the top of His voice.

74 He spent that day there in this joy, and in the evening He returned to Akrūra and took His meal.

75 In the morning He bathed at Cīra-ghāṭa in Vṛndāvana, and then He came to Tẽtula-talā and rested there.

76 That ancient tree dates from the time of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, and beneath it is a raised platform, beautifully smooth.

77 The Yamunā flows nearby, and a cool breeze blows. He gazed at the beauty of Vṛndāvana and at the waters of the Yamunā.

78 Sitting beneath the tamarind tree, He performed saṅkīrtana of the holy name, and after His midday duties He would return to Akrūra for His meal.

79 The people of Akrūra would come to see the Lord, and in the crowd He could not perform kīrtana freely.

80 So the Lord would come to Vṛndāvana, sit in solitude and perform saṅkīrtana of the holy name until midday.

81 In the third watch of the day people would have His darśana, and He taught everyone the saṅkīrtana of the holy name.

82 At that time a Vaiṣṇava named Kṛṣṇadāsa came. He was a Rajput by birth and a householder, and his village was across the Yamunā.

83 After bathing at Keśī-tīrtha, he was on his way to Kālīya-daha when he suddenly saw the Lord at Āmli-talā.

84 Seeing the Lord's beauty and love, he was amazed, and in the rapture of love he bowed down to the Lord.

85 The Lord asked, "Who are you? Where is your home?" Kṛṣṇadāsa said, "I am a wretched householder.

86 I am a Rajput by birth, and my home is on the other bank. My desire is to become a servant of the Vaiṣṇavas.

87 Today I had a dream, and now, coming here, I have found You: the dream has come true before my eyes."

88 The Lord showed him mercy and embraced him. Kṛṣṇadāsa became intoxicated with love; he danced and cried, "Hari!"

89 At midday he came with the Lord to Akrūra-tīrtha and received the prasāda left on the Lord's plate.

90 The next morning he came with the Lord, carrying His waterpot. Leaving home, wife and son, he stayed with the Lord.

91 "Kṛṣṇa has appeared again in Vṛndāvana!" — so people began to say everywhere.

92 One day, early in the morning, people came from Vṛndāvana to Akrūra, making a great uproar.

93 Seeing the Lord, the people bowed to His feet. The Lord asked, “Where have you come from?”

94 The people said, “Kṛṣṇa has appeared in the waters of Kālīya’s lake! He dances on Kālīya’s heads, and the jewels on the serpent’s hoods are blazing.

95 People have seen Him with their own eyes; there is no doubt about it.” Hearing this, the Lord laughed and said, “It is all true.”

96 In this way people went there for three nights, and they all came back saying, “We have had darśana of Kṛṣṇa.”

97 Before the Lord the people said, “We have seen Śrī Kṛṣṇa!” Through these words Sarasvatī made them speak the truth.

98 In seeing Mahāprabhu they truly had darśana of Kṛṣṇa; but through their own ignorance they set the truth aside and mistook the untrue for the true.

99 Then the Bhaṭṭācārya said at the Lord’s feet, “Give me permission, and I shall go and have darśana of Kṛṣṇa!”

100 Then the Lord gave him a slap and said, “You are a learned man, yet you have become a fool by listening to the words of fools.

101 Why would Kṛṣṇa give darśana in the age of Kali? Foolish people are making an uproar out of their own delusion.

102 Do not go mad. Stay at home and sit quietly. You can go tomorrow night and have darśana of Kṛṣṇa.”

103 In the morning some respectable people came to the Lord, and the Lord asked them, “Have you come from seeing Kṛṣṇa?”

104 They said, “At night a fisherman gets into a boat, lights a torch and catches fish in Kālīya’s lake.

105 Seeing this from a distance, people are deluded: ‘Kṛṣṇa is dancing on Kālīya’s body!’

106 They take the boat for Kālīya and the lamp for his jewels, and these foolish people regard the fisherman as Kṛṣṇa!”

107 That Kṛṣṇa had come to Vṛndāvana was also true, and that the people had seen Kṛṣṇa was not false.

108 But some saw Kṛṣṇa, while others accepted an illusion, just as one mistakes a bare tree trunk for a man.

109 The Lord asked, “Then where have you had darśana of Kṛṣṇa?” The people said, “You are a sannyāsī, a moving Nārāyaṇa.

110 In Vṛndāvana You have become an avatāra of Kṛṣṇa, and by seeing You everyone has been delivered.”

111 The Lord said, “Viṣṇu! Viṣṇu! Do not say such a thing! Never take a lowly jīva for Kṛṣṇa!

112 A sannyāsī is a jīva, a particle of spirit, like a particle of a ray of light; but Kṛṣṇa, full of the six opulences, is like the sun.

113 The jīva and the Lord are never equal, just as a tiny spark is never equal to a great blazing fire.

114 “The Lord, embraced by the hlādinī and saṁvit potencies, is eternal being, consciousness and bliss; the jīva, covered by its own ignorance, is a

mine of countless miseries." (quoted by Śrīdhara Svāmī in his commentary on Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 1.7.6)

115 "The fool who says that the jīva is 'equal' to the Lord is a 'pāṣaṇḍī,' and Yama punishes him.

116 'One who regards the Lord Nārāyaṇa as merely equal to Brahmā, Rudra and the other gods is surely a pāṣaṇḍī.'" (Vaiṣṇava-tantra)

117 The people said, "We never think of You as a jīva. Your form and nature are like Kṛṣṇa's.

118 "By Your features we see that You are the son of the king of Vraja; the luster of Your body has only covered You like a yellow garment.

119 "Musk may be tied up in cloth, yet it does not stay hidden; just so, Your nature as the Lord cannot be concealed.

120 "Your nature is extraordinary, beyond the reach of the intellect. Seeing You, the world goes mad with love for Kṛṣṇa.

121–122 "Women, children and old men, even caṇḍālas and yavanas — whoever sees You even once takes the name of Kṛṣṇa and dances as if mad. He becomes an ācārya and delivers the world.

123 "Let alone seeing You — whoever only hears Your name becomes mad with love for Kṛṣṇa and delivers the three worlds.

124 "Hearing Your name, even a dog-eater becomes a purifier of others. Your extraordinary power cannot be described.

125 "O Lord, if even a dog-eater hears and chants Your name, bows down to You or remembers You but once, he is instantly made fit to perform

Vedic sacrifice. How much more, then, one who sees You!" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 3.33.6)

126 "Such glories are Your marginal characteristics (*taṭastha-lakṣaṇa*); by Your essential characteristic (*svarūpa-lakṣaṇa*) You are the son of the king of Vraja."

127 The Lord showed mercy to all those people, and, mad with love for Kṛṣṇa, they went back to their homes.

128 In this way He stayed some days at Akrūra, delivering the people by giving them the name of Kṛṣṇa and love for Him.

129 That brāhmaṇa, the disciple of Mādhava Purī, had invitations for the Lord arranged from house to house in Mathurā.

130 All the people of Mathurā — brāhmaṇas and respectable folk — came to Bhaṭṭācārya to invite the Lord.

131 In a single day ten or twenty invitations would come, but Bhaṭṭācārya would accept only one.

132 People could not find a chance to give their invitations, so they pleaded with that brāhmaṇa to have them accepted.

133 Vedic brāhmaṇas of Kānyakubja and of the south humbly invited Mahāprabhu.

134 They would come to Akrūra in the morning and cook, and after offering the food to the śālagrāma they would give it to the Lord as His meal.

135 One day Mahāprabhu sat at that Akrūra-ghāṭa and reflected:

136 “At this ghāṭa Akrūra saw Vaikuṇṭha, and the people of Vraja had a vision of Goloka.”

137 With these words He leapt into the water, and the Lord stayed submerged beneath it.

138 Seeing this, Kṛṣṇadāsa wept and cried out, and Bhaṭṭācārya quickly came and pulled the Lord out.

139 Then Bhaṭṭācārya took that brāhmaṇa aside, and sitting in a secluded place they made a plan.

140 “Today I was here, and I pulled the Lord out. But if He dives in at Vṛndāvana, who will pull Him out?

141 “The crowds of people, the bother of invitations, the Lord’s constant absorption — I do not think it good.

142 “If we take the Lord away from Vṛndāvana, all will be well. This is a good plan.”

143 The brāhmaṇa said, “Let us take the Lord to Prayāga. If we go by the road along the bank of the Ganges, the journey will be pleasant.

144 “Let us first go to Soro-kṣetra and bathe in the Ganges, and then travel on that road with the Lord.

145 “The month of Māgha has begun. If we go now, we shall have some days of bathing at Prayāga during Makara.

146 “Tell Him something of your own distress, and mention the full moon of Makara (*makara-pañcasi*) at Prayāga.

147 “Tell Him too how pleasant the road along the Ganges is.” Then Bhaṭṭācārya came and spoke to the Lord:

148 “I cannot bear the commotion of these people. They jostle one another to invite You.

149 “People come in the morning and do not find You; and when they do not find You, they pester me to death.

150 “I would be happy if we went by the Ganges road. If we go now, we shall be able to bathe in the Ganges during Makara.

151 “My heart is troubled; I cannot bear it. Whatever the Lord commands, I will accept on my head.”

152 Although the Lord had no wish to leave Vṛndāvana, to fulfill His devotee’s wish He spoke sweet words:

153 “You brought Me here and showed Me Vṛndāvana. I shall never be able to repay this debt.

154 “Whatever you wish, that I will do. Wherever you take Me, there I will go.”

155 In the morning Mahāprabhu took His morning bath, and at the thought “I am leaving Vṛndāvana” He was overwhelmed with love.

156 There were no outward transformations, but His heart was absorbed in love. Bhaṭṭācārya said, “Come, let us go to Mahāvana.”

157 Saying this, Bhaṭṭācārya seated Mahāprabhu in a boat, took Him across the river and set off with Him.

158 Kṛṣṇadāsa, full of love, and that brāhmaṇa — these two knew the road along the Ganges well.

159 On the way the Lord saw that everyone was tired from walking, and He sat down with them all beneath a tree.

160 Many cows were grazing near that tree, and the sight of them filled Mahāprabhu's heart with joy.

161 Suddenly a cowherd played on his flute, and hearing it, Mahāprabhu was overwhelmed with great love.

162 The Lord fell unconscious to the ground; foam came from His mouth, and the breath in His nostrils stopped.

163 Just then ten horsemen arrived there — mleccha Paṭhāns — and dismounted from their horses.

164 Seeing the Lord, the mlecchas reasoned: "This sannyāsī had boundless gold.

165 "These four highwaymen fed him dhuturā, killed him and took all the sannyāsī's wealth."

166 Then the Paṭhāns bound the four men and wanted to cut them down. The Bengalis all began to tremble.

167 Kṛṣṇadāsa was a Rajput and utterly fearless. That brāhmaṇa too was fearless, and very bold of speech.

168 The brāhmaṇa said, "Paṭhān, I appeal to you in the name of your pādśāh! Come along — I will go with you before the sikdār.

169 “This sannyāsī is my guru, and I am a brāhmaṇa of Mathurā. I have a hundred men at the pādśāh’s court.

170 “Because of an illness this sannyāsī sometimes faints. He will soon regain consciousness and come to His senses.

171 “Sit here a moment and keep us all bound. Ask Him, and then kill me.”

172 The Paṭhān said, “You two are Westerners from Mathurā, and these two Bengali cheats are trembling.”

173 Kṛṣṇadāsa said, “My home is in this village. There are two hundred Turks there and a hundred guns.

174 “If I give the signal, they will all come at once, kill you all and carry off your horses and saddles.

175 “The Bengalis are not highwaymen — you are the highwaymen! You rob pilgrims and want to kill them besides.”

176 Hearing this, the Paṭhāns began to hesitate. Just then Mahāprabhu regained consciousness.

177 He rose with a loud roar, calling “Hari! Hari!”, and absorbed in love He danced with His arms raised high.

178 When the Lord, absorbed in love, cried out, it pierced the mlecchas’ hearts like the point of a spear.

179 Frightened, the mlecchas set the four men free, and the Lord did not see His companions in bonds.

180 Bhaṭṭācārya came, took hold of the Lord and seated Him. Seeing the mlecchas, Mahāprabhu returned to outward consciousness.

181 The mlecchas came and bowed at the Lord's feet, and before Him they said, "These four men are cheats.

182 "These four together fed You dhuturā, made You lose Your senses and took Your wealth."

183 The Lord said, "They are not cheats; they are My companions. I am a mendicant sannyāsī and have no wealth at all.

184 "Because of the falling sickness I sometimes lose consciousness, and these four kindly look after Me."

185 Among those mlecchas was one very grave man. He wore black clothes, and people called him a 'pīr.'

186 His heart melted when he saw the Lord, and, citing his own scripture, he set out to establish the impersonal (*nirviśeṣa*) Brahman.

187 He set forth the doctrine of the nondual Brahman, and the Lord refuted him with the reasoning of his own scripture.

188 Whatever he said, the Lord refuted it all. No answer came to his lips, and he was struck utterly dumb.

189 The Lord said, "Your scripture establishes the impersonal, but in the end it refutes that and establishes the personal (*saviśeṣa*).

190 "At the end your scripture speaks of 'one God alone,' 'full of all majesty,' whose form is dark.

191 “His body is eternity, knowledge and bliss; He is the complete Brahman in person. He is ‘the Soul of all’ and ‘the Knower of all,’ the eternal origin of all.

192 “Creation, maintenance and dissolution come from Him; He is the shelter of the gross and subtle worlds.

193 “He is ‘the highest of all, worshipable by all, the cause of all causes.’ By devotion to Him the jīva is delivered from saṁsāra.

194 “Without serving Him, the jīva is never free of saṁsāra. Love for His feet is ‘the essence of all human goals.’

195 “The joy of liberation and the like is not a particle of that bliss: to serve His feet is to attain complete bliss.

196 “First it establishes karma, jñāna and yoga, but then it refutes them all and establishes ‘God’ and ‘service to Him.’

197 “Your scholars do not know the scripture. Among earlier and later injunctions, the later one prevails.

198 “Look into your own scripture, consider it carefully, and tell Me plainly what it has written at the end.”

199 The mleccha said, “What You say is true. It is written in the scripture, but no one can accept it.

200 “They interpret everything in terms of the impersonal Lord. That the Lord with form is the one to be served — no one knows this.

201 “You are that very Lord — God Himself. Be merciful to me; I am an unworthy sinner.

202 “I have studied much of the mleccha scriptures, yet I cannot determine what the goal is and what the means.

203 “Seeing You, my tongue speaks the name of Kṛṣṇa, and my pride — ‘I am a great scholar’ — is gone.

204 “Be merciful and tell me of the goal and the means.” Saying this, he fell at Mahāprabhu’s feet.

205 The Lord said, “Rise. You have taken the name of Kṛṣṇa. The sins of millions of births are gone; you have become pure.”

206 He instructed them, “Say ‘Kṛṣṇa’! Say ‘Kṛṣṇa’!” They all said “Kṛṣṇa,” and all were overwhelmed with love.

207 The Lord gave him the name ‘Rāmadāsa.’ Another Paṭhān there was named ‘Bijalī Khān.’

208 He was young, the son of a king, and Rāmadāsa and the other Paṭhāns were his servants.

209 Saying “Kṛṣṇa,” he fell at Mahāprabhu’s feet, and the Lord placed His holy foot on his head.

210 Having shown mercy to them all, the Lord went on His way, and those Paṭhāns all became renunciants.

211 They became famous as the ‘Paṭhān Vaiṣṇavas,’ and they wandered everywhere singing the glories of Mahāprabhu.

212 That Bijalī Khān became a mahā-bhāgavata, and his greatness was renowned at every holy place.

213 Such are the pastimes of the Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya. Coming to the West, He blessed the yavanas and others.

214 Coming to Soro-kṣetra, the Lord bathed in the Ganges, and then He set out for Prayāga by the road along the Ganges.

215 There the Lord bade farewell to that brāhmaṇa and to Kṛṣṇadāsa, but the two folded their hands and said:

216 “We two will go with You as far as Prayāga. Where shall we ever again find the company of Your feet?

217 “This is a land of mlecchas, and someone somewhere may make trouble. Bhaṭṭācārya is a scholar; he does not know how to talk to them.”

218 Hearing this, Mahāprabhu smiled slightly, and the two went on with the Lord.

219 Whoever saw the Lord became mad with love and began the saṅkīrtana of Kṛṣṇa’s names.

220 Through their company others in turn, and through those others still more — in this way He made Vaiṣṇavas of all the lands and villages.

221 Just as He displayed His power when He went to the South, so too He flooded the West with love.

222 Traveling in this way, the Lord came to Prayāga, and for ten days He took the Makara bath at Triveṇī.

223 His journey to Vṛndāvana, the Lord’s deeds — they are endless; even the thousand-mouthed Śeṣa cannot reach their end.

224 Who, being a tiny jīva, could describe them? I have only given a glimpse, setting it down in brief.

225 The Lord's pastimes are extraordinary, and His ways are extraordinary; even hearing of them, the unfortunate do not believe.

226 Know that Caitanya's pastimes are extraordinary from beginning to end. Hear them with faith and accept them as true.

227 Whoever argues about this is a 'king of fools'; he brings a thunderbolt down on his own head.

228 These deeds of Caitanya are an 'ocean of nectar'; a single drop of it floods the world with bliss.

229 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Madhya 4.2 (the refrain of Ādi 4.2 with *gauracandra* in the first line); translation as there. ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 4.215 and Madhya 8.98; translation as there. ↩
3. According to the *Anubhāṣya*, the gopīs sing this verse: wandering in longing for Kṛṣṇa, they see before them Govardhana, the king of mountains, nondifferent from Vrajendranandana. ↩
4. The same verse as Madhya 8.218; translation as there. ↩